

What Does Big Data Mean to You

Big Data is a combination of structured, semi-structured, and unstructured data collected by organisations that can be used for machine learning, predictive modelling, fraud detection, sentiment analysis, and other advanced analytics applications. Let us take a detailed look at it.

The number of companies, organisations and institutions that use Big Data solutions today has exploded in recent years, as has the amount of data collected. Some estimates put the total amount of data generated daily at 2.5 trillion bytes! Such a number is difficult to understand, let alone harness, and yet companies have eagerly embraced Big Data analytics for their lofty goals. We are only just beginning to understand how revolutionary Big Data could be, and with it really taking off, we can expect a gamut of changes with respect to how business is done in the coming years.

There are a variety of tools for analysing Big Data like NoSQL, Hadoop, and Cassandra. These tools allow us to collect different types of data from a wide variety of sources — digital media, Web services, business applications, machine log data, etc.

What is Big Data all about?

Big Data refers to the huge and diverse amounts of information available and growing each day. This includes the amount of data, the speed at which it is created and collected, and the variety of the data points collected. It comes from multiple sources and arrives in several formats (csv, tsv, html, json, parquet, avro). There's a misconception that Big Data should be the size of a terabyte,



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zettabyte, or even exa-byte — but it isn't.

The size depends on where the data is being used. For example, you have a 50MB file and want to email it as an attachment, but you can't because it is too big. In this scenario, this '50MB' file is referred to as Big Data.

Using Big Data has become easier with the increasing number of Big Data providers. Today we live in the age of Big Data, in which breakthroughs and revolutionary changes take place at regular intervals.

Companies use Big Data to improve their operations, make better decisions, provide better customer service, create personalised marketing campaigns based on specific customer preferences, and ultimately increase profitability. Companies that use Big Data have an advantage over those that don't because they can make faster and better-informed business decisions

For example, Big Data can provide companies with valuable information about their customers that can be used to refine marketing campaigns to increase customer engagement and conversion rates.

Applications

Big Data allows companies to focus more and more on the customer. Real-time and historical data can be used to assess changing consumer preferences, allowing companies to update and improve their marketing strategies and be more responsive to customer wants and needs.

Medical researchers and physicians also use Big Data to identify risk factors for diseases as well as to help diagnose these in patients. Additionally, data derived from electronic medical records, social media, the Web, and other sources provides healthcare organisations and government agencies with up-to-the-